

Important Papers Checklist for Aging Parents

Know where the most important documents are before you urgently need them. Start with what you can find, leave blanks where needed, and keep the completed checklist somewhere secure.

Privacy note: This checklist is for personal/family use. Parent Stay Home does not receive, save, store, or see anything written here. Share only with people your parent trusts or has authorized. General information only - not legal, financial, medical, or care-management advice.

Parent basic information

Parent's full name	Preferred name
Primary phone	Best person to contact first
Street address	
City	State / ZIP

Important document tracker

Use this table to note whether a document exists, where it is kept, and who can access it. Avoid writing full account numbers, passwords, or sensitive details unless this page will be stored securely.

#	Document / information	Exists?	Where kept	Who can access / notes
1	Will or estate plan			
2	Power of attorney			
3	Advance directive / healthcare proxy			
4	Health insurance / Medicare cards			
5	Prescription plan information			
6	Medication list			
7	Bank or credit union information			
8	Pension, Social Security, or VA benefits			
9	Tax records			
10	Property deed, lease, or mortgage information			
11	Vehicle title / registration / insurance			
12	Funeral, burial, or final arrangement information			

Legal and decision-making documents

These documents may affect who can help with decisions or access information. Confirm requirements with an attorney, healthcare provider, or another qualified professional when needed.

- ☐ Will
- ☐ Financial power of attorney
- ☐ Advance directive / living will
- ☐ Do Not Resuscitate / MOLST / POLST form, if applicable
- ☐ Trust documents
- ☐ Healthcare power of attorney / proxy
- ☐ Guardianship or conservatorship papers, if applicable
- ☐ Attorney contact information

Notes or location of legal documents

Insurance, benefits, and medical information

Use this section to locate cards, letters, portals, and contacts. Do not cancel, change, or apply for benefits based only on a checklist; verify current rules with the relevant agency or qualified advisor.

- ☐ Medicare card
- ☐ Supplemental insurance
- ☐ Long-term care insurance
- ☐ Social Security information
- ☐ Medicaid information, if applicable
- ☐ Prescription drug plan
- ☐ Veterans benefits information
- ☐ Doctor and medication lists

Insurance, benefits, or medical document notes

Financial and household records

This section is meant to help families locate information, not take over decisions. Share financial information only with authorized, trusted people.

- ☐ Bank / credit union names
- ☐ Pension / retirement account contacts
- ☐ Utility account information
- ☐ Home insurance
- ☐ Credit card or loan information
- ☐ Regular bills and due dates
- ☐ Tax preparer contact
- ☐ Safe deposit box location, if any

Where financial and household records are kept

Digital access and security

Do not write passwords here unless this page will be stored securely. A safer approach may be to note where passwords are stored and who is authorized to access them.

- Password manager or password book location
- Email account access notes
- Two-factor authentication / backup code notes
- Phone/computer unlock help
- Important online account notes
- Trusted person who can help with technology

Digital access instructions

Final arrangements and wishes

This can be a tender subject. Note what is already documented and where information can be found. Share and discuss in ways that respect your parent's dignity, wishes, and readiness.

- Funeral home contact
- Cemetery or burial information
- Prepaid or preplanned arrangements
- Obituary or memorial wishes
- Religious/spiritual/community contacts
- Important people to notify

Location of final arrangement documents or wishes

Additional notes

Reminder: Review this checklist after moves, health changes, account changes, new professionals, or major family updates.